



Harry's YUV Intensity filter turned Notre Dame into the product of a psychedelic dream

example, adds a starburst to the lighter areas for the image. You can even paint over areas of the image to decide where an effect will be applied, or alternatively, erase the effect from areas where you don't want it.



Create movie-style sparkles using PixelSampler's StarPoint

## Virtual Photographer

Suggestive enough by name, Virtual Photographer gives you all you need to tweak photos in the manner of the professionals—choose your



These ruins benefit from the stark Fashion filter in Virtual Photographer

film type, speed or photographic filters. The collection of presets, even categorised under colour and black-and-white, are sure to keep you busy for a while—be it the soft-focus and “glowy” look of Glamour, or the grim, horror-movie look of Spooky.

## The VanDerLee Collection

These five individually available filters aren't really intended to be more than fun, but as you can see in the picture above, they can be used to very interesting ends. The Camouflage filter generates (what else?) camouflage patterns, the Harmonix plugin will let you create your own wave, the NightVision plugin alters the image to look like you're watching it through night vision goggles.



It wasn't snowing when this picture was taken—the VanDerLee SnowScape and Snowflake filters did that!

## Some Honourable Mentions

While the plugins featured above are doubtless our current favourites, a few more deserve to be worthy mentions:

**WallPampered:** This one lets you set an image as your desktop wallpaper from within Photoshop itself. It even lets you select the co-ordinates of your image rather than the plain old Tiled, Centred or Stretched. After installing, you can access it from File > Automate.

**Thredgeholder:** A slightly more advanced version of Find Edges, this allows you to specify a threshold for bringing out the edges in a picture.

**ICOFormat:** This enables Photoshop to open icon (.ico) files for editing, and save them as well.

**Pinocchio:** A simple warp effect, Pinocchio lets you drag a portion of the image out for a “long nose” look.

## Endnote

When you install a large number of new plugins, you run the risk of slowing down Photoshop considerably. If you find this too annoying, download Photoshop SpeedUp from [www.acropdf.com](http://www.acropdf.com), which lets you select what plugins to load at Photoshop's startup.

Finally, there are a lot more free plugins out there, and if you have the programming skills, you can even make your own! FilterMeister (on our CD this month) is a tool for creating Photoshop plugins, and with some basic knowledge of image processing, you can get cracking at your own. Now, pop in that DVD and plug them all in! ■

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